Student interview and suitability record: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot answer in English, one or two answers may be given in Chinese so that you learn about the student: mark them "C" and do not count them towards the speaking band.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 5 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?	
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?	
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?	
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?	
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?	
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?	
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?	
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?	
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?	
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?	
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?	
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?	
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?	
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.	
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?	
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?	
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best. Use the evidence from the whole interview.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning).

Interviewer signature and date _____